Human vs. Machine: counselor guide

8 minutes · whole class

The idea

One scout plays the Machine and follows the rules exactly. A teammate plays the Human and sorts by instinct while also answering trivia. The squad compares speed and mistakes, then talks about where machines win and where people are still needed.

The three rules (also on the Machine Rule Card)

- TRIGGER: if the card is RED.
- TASK: put it in bin A. (Anything not red goes in bin B.)
- VARIABLE: add one to the red count (a tally mark on the scorecard).

Print and prep, per squad

- 1 deck of 24 cards (pages 3 and 4). Cut on the dotted lines. Shuffle. Cards: 10 red, 5 blue, 5 green, 3 yellow, 1 pink.
- 2 bin labels, A and B (page 2). Fold in half or tape to paper plates, cups or tape marks on the floor.
- 1 Machine Rule Card (page 2) and 1 scorecard (page 6), one per squad.
- 1 trivia list for you (page 5). Read one question at a time, in order.
- A phone timer. No other supplies.

How to run it (RELAY: squads line up behind their bins)

- Round 1 (about 2 min): Scout 1 is the MACHINE. Scout 2 is the HUMAN. The Machine sorts the whole deck following the rules, exactly, while the squad times it. Then the Human sorts a reshuffled deck while you read trivia questions out loud. The Human must answer each one out loud before taking the next card, and is told only: "Put the red cards in bin A."
- Count for each: seconds to finish, cards in the wrong bin, and the red count. The squad checks: did the red count match the real number of red cards?
- Round 2 (about 2 min): swap. Pick two new scouts. Repeat. Everyone who is not playing is the timer, counter and judge.
- The exception (about 1 min): include the PINK card. Ask: "Is pink red?" Watch what the Machine does (follows the rules exactly, so pink goes in bin B, or it freezes). What does the Human do?

Score it (suggested)

- Squads earn 5 XP for a complete scorecard and a style point for the best explanation of where the machine was better or worse. Initial Passports after the debrief.

Debrief (the last 2 minutes)

- Where was the machine better? (Consistent, tireless, accurate count.)
- Where was it worse? (Exceptions, like the pink card. No judgment.)
- Why do real workflows still need humans? (Someone writes the rules and handles surprises.)
- Tie back to the Level 3 Boss Challenge: what safeguard would catch a mistake?

Machine Rule Card and bin labels

one per squad · cut and fold

MACHINE RULE CARD

Follow these rules EXACTLY. Do not think. Do not guess.

TRIGGER	If the card is RED
TASK	Put it in bin A. (not red: bin B)
VARIABLE	Add one to the red count.

A

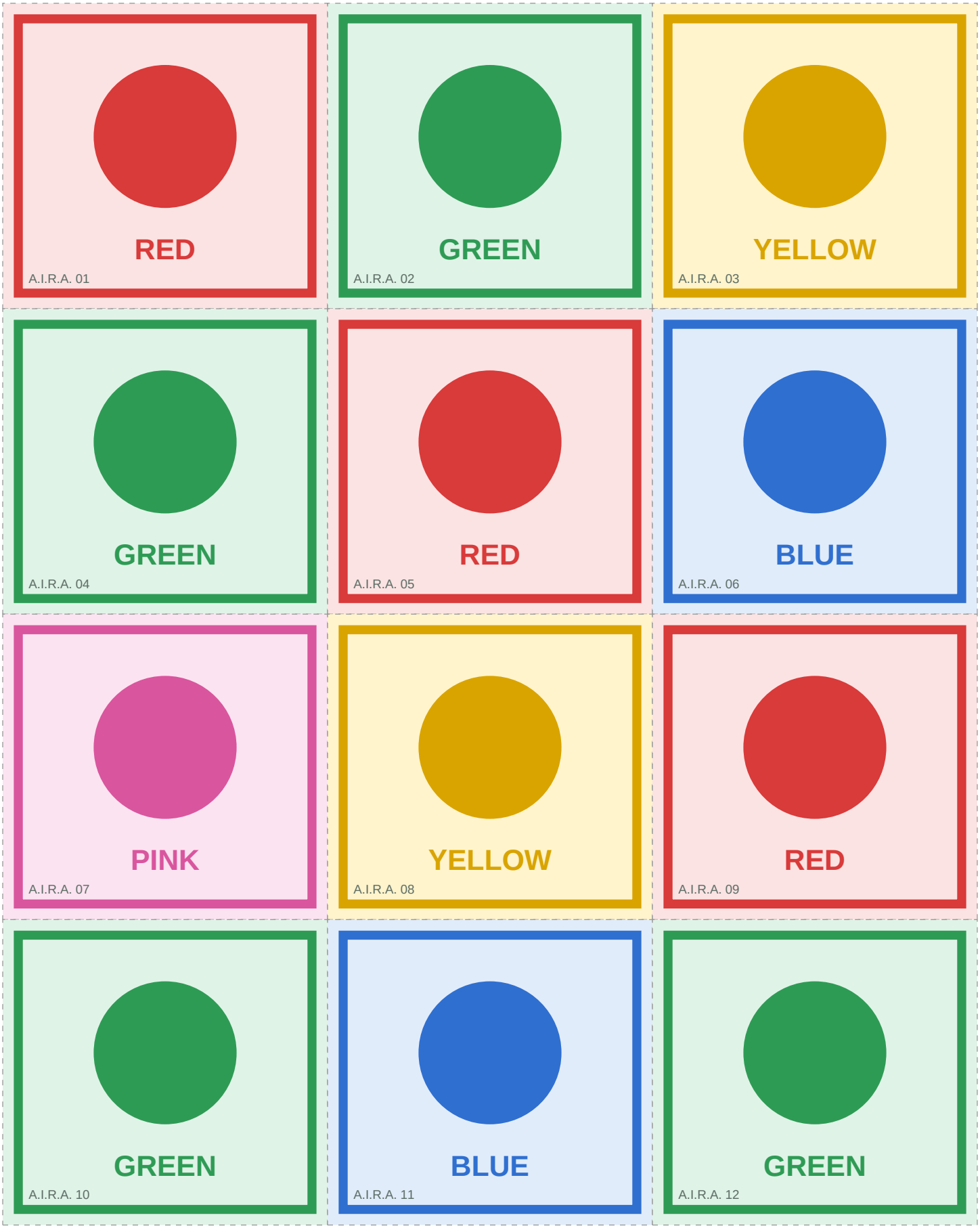
BIN A · RED CARDS GO HERE

B

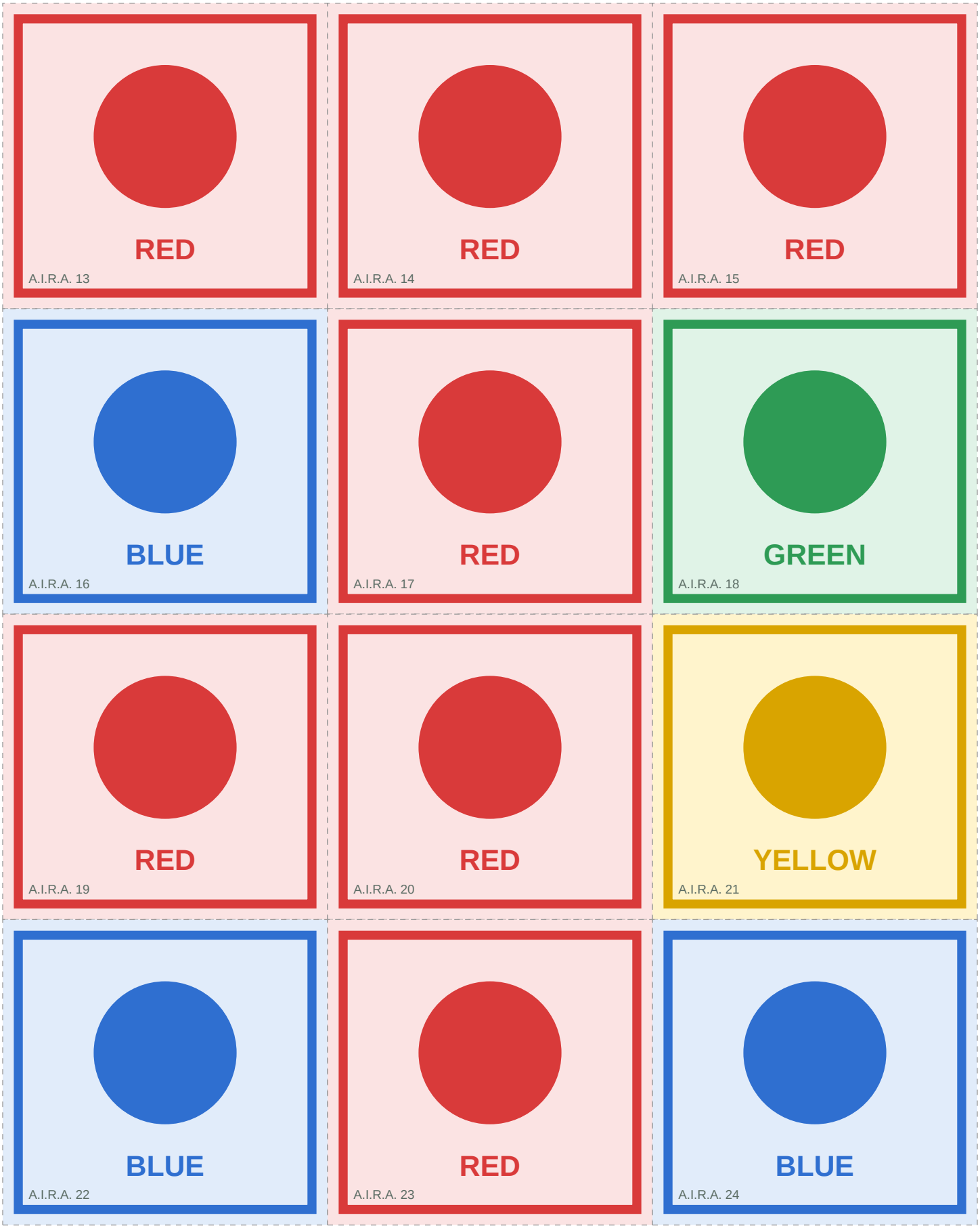
BIN B · EVERYTHING ELSE

Cut out the rule card and the two bin labels. Tape the labels to plates, cups or the floor, six feet apart.

CARD DECK, sheet 1 of 2. Cut on the dotted lines. 24 cards per squad. Color word printed on every card.



CARD DECK, sheet 2 of 2. Cut on the dotted lines. 24 cards per squad. Color word printed on every card.



Trivia for the Human

counselor only · read one at a time

The Human answers each question out loud before touching the next card. Skip any you do not like. Answers are in the right column.

1. What is the Scout motto?	**Be Prepared.**
2. How many points are in the Scout Law?	**12.**
3. What do you call the knot used to join two ropes of equal size?	**A square knot (reef knot).**
4. What planet is closest to the Sun?	**Mercury.**
5. How many sides does a hexagon have?	**6.**
6. What gas do plants take in from the air?	**Carbon dioxide.**
7. What is 7 times 8?	**56.**
8. What is the capital of Florida?	**Tallahassee.**
9. What is the largest ocean?	**The Pacific.**
10. How many minutes are in two hours?	**120.**
11. What do the letters in the word AI stand for?	**Artificial intelligence.**
12. What is the freezing point of water in Fahrenheit?	**32 degrees.**
13. Name the first two points of the Scout Law.	**Trustworthy and Loyal.**
14. How many continents are there?	**7.**
15. What is the opposite of north on a compass?	**South.**
16. What is 15 plus 27?	**42.**
17. What is the hardest natural material?	**Diamond.**
18. How many legs does a spider have?	**8.**
19. Which direction does the sun rise?	**East.**
20. How many players are on a standard soccer team on the field?	**11.**
21. What color do you get from mixing blue and yellow?	**Green.**
22. How many days are in a leap year?	**366.**
23. What do bees make?	**Honey.**
24. What is 100 divided by 4?	**25.**

Squad scorecard

one per squad

Squad: _____

Round	Role	Player	Seconds	Wrong bin	Red count (tally)	Correct count?
1	Machine					
1	Human					
2	Machine					
2	Human					

The pink card

What did the Machine do with the pink card?

What did the Human do with it?

Debrief

Where was the machine better?

Where was the machine worse?

Why do real workflows still need humans?

Check the red count against the deck: the correct red count is 10.